



Kindle isn't just an e-reader anymore, thanks to AI

One thing that has been holding Amazon's Kindle back over the years is probably its limited usability. What if you could do more than just read books on your Kindle? It would open up a new world of possibilities, right?

That's exactly what Amazon has done by making Kindle a productivity device. Last month, Amazon expanded its Kindle family with the launch of two new products – a refreshed Kindle Scribe and the company's first color e-reader, the Kindle Scribe Colorsoft. Both models are equipped with upgraded hardware and new AI-driven tools aimed at improving reading and note-taking experiences. Both aim to make Kindle an e-reader and a writing tablet.

The latest Kindle Scribe features an 11-inch glare-free screen, measuring just 5.4mm thick and weighing 400 grams. It's ridiculously thin. We are taking iPhone Air territory here and you don't get such thin tablets anymore.

Also, the new processor means that writing is so much smoother and better on this tablet. Amazon claims that the latency of the stylus or pen has gone down to under 12 m/s, giving you almost a paper-like writing experience. A texture-molded glass panel has also been added to mimic the resistance of pen on paper, giving handwritten notes a more natural feel. The device will be available in two versions:

- **With front light:** launching later this year in the US starting at \$499.99
- **Without front light:** coming early next year for \$429.99

The highlight of the event was the debut of the Kindle Scribe Colorsoft, priced at \$629.99. The new e-reader introduces display technology that produces muted and eye-friendly colors. These are designed to be less harsh than LCD screens. To power the experience, Amazon has developed a new rendering engine that makes both writing and color reproduction faster and smoother. Amazon says both these devices should come to India soon.

Amazon launches new Echo Dot and Echo Show with Alexa+ integration

In one of its most exciting events in recent times, Amazon refreshed the entire Echo portfolio with new speakers and smart displays, all designed to showcase the company's upgraded AI assistant, Alexa+. The updated lineup includes the Echo Dot Max, Echo Studio, Echo Show 8 and the Echo Show 11. Each device ships with greater processing power, more memory and deeper Alexa+ integration through and through.

With Alexa+, the smart speakers and displays can handle more natural conversations, respond to complex queries and will eventually support third-party add-ons through a dedicated Alexa+



Store. Subscribers will also be able to link Alexa+ with Amazon services like Amazon Music, Amazon Kids+, or Alexa Emergency Assist, customising how the assistant works across entertainment, safety, and family activities.

New Echo devices

All four devices run on Amazon's in-house silicon – the new AZ3 and AZ3 Pro chips. The AZ3 chip, found in the Echo Dot Max, is optimised for faster wake-word detection and improved conversation recognition, even in noisy rooms. The same chip will also power the Echo Show devices. These devices also integrate Omnisense, Amazon's new sensor platform that combines inputs from the 13MP camera, audio, ultrasound, Wi-Fi radar, accelerometer and Wi-Fi channel state information. These devices will come to India soon.